

Data Layer

In a CD-R, the organic dye sandwiched between the polycarbonate substrate and the metalised reflective layer of the media. CD-Recordable discs do not have any data on them until they are recorded. The recording laser selectively melts 'pits' into the dye layer: rather than burning holes in the dye, it melts it slightly, causing it to become non-translucent so the reading laser beam is refracted rather than reflected back to the reader's sensors. In pressed CDs, the data layer is part of the polycarbonate substrate, and is pressed into the top side of it by a stamper during the injection moulding process.

Data Transfer Rate

The speed with which data can be read from a CD ROM drive. 150 kilobytes per second, or 1x, was the original standard rate; 2x equals 300 kb/second; 4x means 600kb/s, and so on.

Digital Audio

Digital audio describes sound recording and reproduction systems that work by using a digital representation of the audio waveform. This usually requires at least 16 bits of linear coding to represent each digital sample.

DVD

A format jointly developed and agreed upon by Toshiba, Matsushita, Sony, Philips, Time Warner, Pioneer, JVC, Hitachi, and Mitsubishi Electronics, which is now the universal format for high-density compact disks. DVD is commonly taken to be an acronym for Digital Versatile Disk or Digital Video Disk. This format can hold much more information than a regular CD can, and has a higher data transfer rate.